

Lighting Booth Runbook

Volunteers: the boxes on this page are all you need. The rest is for when something goes wrong, and for whoever looks after the Mac. The MacBook is shut down after every use; leave everything plugged in, including the USB cable to the blue ENTTEC Open DMX box.

Starting a service

About two minutes. Most of it happens by itself.

- 1 Open the MacBook and press the power button.**
- 2 Type the password.**
It's written on the MacBook.
- 3 Wait. Don't click anything yet.**
A panel at the top right ticks through the start-up: Booth Check finds the DMX box, then opens Lightkey. If it says to unplug and replug, it means the USB cable in the blue box: pull it out and plug it back in.
- 4 In Lightkey, click the most recent project**
(BackupChurch_modular).
- 5 Tap Authenticate on the Touch Bar, and type the password again.**
That's Lightkey connecting to the lights.
- 6 Test: press House 10% on the Stream Deck, then press it again.**
The lights come up, then go off. You're ready.

Ending a service

Shut down every time.

- 1 Haze off.**
Stream Deck, Punch FX & Haze page: press Haze Off.
- 2 Stage lights off.**
Stream Deck, Worship Colour page: press Stage Off.
- 3 Apple menu → Shut Down.**
- 4 Close the lid.**
Leave everything plugged in.

Something not working?

- 1 Restart the whole MacBook:** Apple menu → Restart, then follow Starting a service from step 2.
- 2 Still not working?** Take a photo of the screen, write down the steps you tried, and send Fynn a message. Sorry for the inconvenience, and thank you.

If the lights run away

Unplug the Stream Deck's USB cable and don't press anything else. If one press changes lots of cues, or Lightkey freezes, this stops it at once.

Run the rest of the service from Lightkey's own panel with the mouse, and send Fynn a message afterwards.

Something's wrong

Find the symptom. "Now" is for whoever is in the booth; "For good" is the one-time setup below.

The Booth Check icon shows a triangle or a cross.

Something it checks needs attention. The number is how many things.

NOW

Click the icon. Each item says what to do; **Open Booth Check** shows the full list, with a button for each fix.

Deck keys do nothing — then they all fire at once when you click the Stream Deck app.

macOS has put the Stream Deck app to sleep. Your presses are queued inside it, not lost.

NOW

Stop pressing — every queued press fires when it wakes. Click the Stream Deck app once.

FOR GOOD

Booth Check switches App Nap off at start-up; quit and reopen Stream Deck once.

A key is lit but its cue isn't on, or the other way round.

The deck can only update keys on the page it's showing. Worship and flow, the two mover pages and the two bar pages share groups across pages.

NOW

Press any key on the page you're looking at. Lightkey's own panel is always right.

The deck does nothing at all, even with the app open.

Wrong profile, or Stream Deck started before Lightkey was ready.

NOW

Pick the newest "Lightkey ... Service Panel" profile. Still dead: quit and reopen the Stream Deck app.

FOR GOOD

Setup 3 and 5, so Booth Check opens them in order.

Cues change in Lightkey but nothing lights up.

The USB DMX interface isn't reaching the lights. Booth Check's two DMX items help tell.

NOW

Reseat the DMX USB cable at both ends, then quit and reopen Lightkey.

Wrong looks, missing buttons or old cues.

An older show file is open.

NOW

File → Open Recent → the newest `BackupChurch_modular`.

FOR GOOD

Booth Check → **Change...** to the right show.

"Allow accessory to connect?" appears, or a password after sitting idle.

Two macOS settings Booth Check can't read.

NOW

Click Allow, or type the password.

FOR GOOD

Setup 4.

The screen went black or the Mac went to sleep.

It's running on battery, or its screen settings turned the display off.

NOW

Plug the charger in, then press a key on the external keyboard.

FOR GOOD

Booth Check's "Never sleeps on the charger" item (setup 3).

One-time setup Done once by whoever looks after the Mac.

- 1 Install Booth Check.** Download **Booth.Check.zip** from github.com/jimhoggey/BoothCheck-App/releases and drag Booth Check into Applications. First time only, unblock it with `xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine "/Applications/Booth Check.app"` in Terminal, or Privacy & Security → **Open Anyway**. After that it updates itself.
- 2 Tell it what this Mac does, allow access.** In **This Mac**, switch on Lightkey (with the DMX option), Stream Deck, Stays on for services, and Start the show when the Mac starts. Allow System Events and Accessibility when asked. **Choose show...** is optional: it skips the volunteer's "click the project" step.
- 3 Work down Booth Check's list until everything is a tick.** Each item says what to do. A change shows its exact command first and runs only when you press Run; most admin changes open System Settings instead.
- 4 The settings Booth Check can't see.** On Apple silicon Macs, Privacy & Security → Allow accessories to connect → **Always** (Intel Macs don't have it). Lock Screen → screen saver and "Require password..." → Never. Control Centre → Focus → Do Not Disturb, on.
- 5 Turn off the Stream Deck app's own "launch at login".** Booth Check opens it once Lightkey is ready; starting on its own, it can beat Lightkey and the keys stay dead.
- 6 Look after the battery.** Always on the charger, an Intel MacBook's battery can swell: turn on battery health management (Battery → ⓘ next to Battery Health), and replace it if the case bulges.
- 7 Install macOS updates between services, never just before one.** The password at start-up is FileVault unlocking the disk; keep it on.